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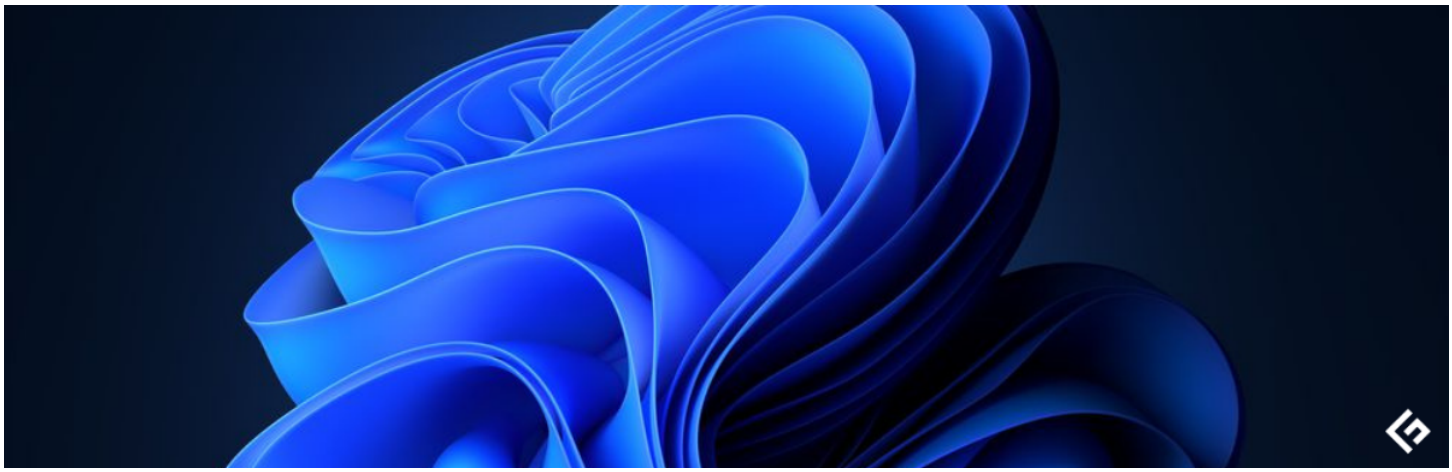
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Fully Customize Your Windows 11 Taskbar – Complete Guide



By Karrar Haider in Sysadmin on February 21, 2022

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> Windows 11 taskbar behaves differently from the previous versions. Its right-click menu is different, its settings have been completely overhauled, and even pinning icons to the taskbar works differently.

After installing Windows 11, the first thing you will probably notice is the changes to the taskbar. There are a bunch of new icons all moved to the middle while Cortana seems to be demoted from the front desk job. These upfront changes are just the tip of the iceberg.

If you are having trouble customizing the new Windows 11 taskbar, then we've got you covered. We will show you how to adjust the Window 11 taskbar to your liking and also share some hacks to access features that are no longer officially available in Windows 11

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Here at the top, you'll see all the taskbar default items with a toggle button next to them. Just toggle off the items you don't want to see on the taskbar, and they will be removed.

2 Move taskbar icons to the left.

I don't mind taskbar icons in the middle, but I still moved them to the left due to the Start menu. In the middle, I have to aim the mouse to click on the Start menu. However, on the far left corner, I can just blindly move the mouse in the bottom-left direction, and it works, which saves me some focus.

If you also want to move the taskbar icons to the left, just go to the taskbar settings as we did above. Here scroll down and open the **Taskbar behaviors** section. Afterward, select **Left** in the **Taskbar alignment** option.

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Windows search and then right-click on it and select **Pin to taskbar**.

To do it from Windows Explorer, you have to first right-click the app icon and select the **Show more** option, and then you'll see the **Pin to taskbar** option.

4 Enable taskbar auto-hide

Windows 11 retains the auto-hide function like in the previous versions, and it can be found in the taskbar settings. Scroll down in the taskbar settings and open the **Taskbar behaviors** section. Here check the checkbox next to the **Automatically hide the taskbar** option. Now, unless you hover the mouse cursor over the taskbar area, the taskbar will stay hidden.

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You can also make the taskbar change its color according to the background and make it look transparent. You have to do it from the Windows 11 settings, here's how:

Click on the **Start menu** and select **Settings** from it.

Here select **Personalization** in the left panel and then click on **Colors**.

Now enable the **Transparency effects** option, and it will make the taskbar transparent.

6 Hide/show system tray icons.

In previous versions of Windows, you could easily hide/show icons in the system tray right from the taskbar. However, in Windows 11, the name of the system tray is changed to Taskbar corner overflow, and you have to manage it from the taskbar settings.

In the taskbar settings, there is a dedicated section for Taskbar corner overflow. You can click on it to open all the apps that can show its icon on the Taskbar corner overflow. You will have to individually toggle on/off apps here to hide/show their icons in the right corner of the taskbar.

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The Show Desktop button on the taskbar is much smaller in Windows 11 and doesn't show the desktop when you hover the mouse pointer on it. However, if you are still not interested in using this feature and feel like it's taking unrequired space on the taskbar, you can disable it.

Go to the taskbar settings and open up the **Taskbar behaviors** section. Here uncheck the option **Select the far corner of the taskbar to show the desktop,** and the button will be removed.

8 Change the taskbar color.

You can also use custom colors for the taskbar that won't be influenced by the color of your theme. Here's how to do it:

In Windows 11 settings, click on **Personalization** in the left panel and then select the **Colors** option.

Here select **Custom** in the **Choose your mode section** and **Dark** in the **Choose your default Windows mode** section.

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Now scroll down and enable the option **Show accent color on Start and taskbar**.

Afterward, set the **Accent color** option to **Manual** and choose any color you like below to select as your taskbar color. You can also open up the **color wheel** by clicking on the **Custom colors** option to set a custom color.

9 Move the taskbar to the top.

The previous versions of Windows allowed you to move the taskbar to the top, left, or right side, but Windows 11 has forced it to stay at the bottom. If you still want to move the taskbar in Windows 11, you'll have to edit the Windows Registry.

Even then, there is no guarantee that the taskbar will work as intended as it's not an official workaround. From my experiences and what other users have reported, moving the taskbar to the left or right completely breaks it. So your only option is to move it to the top. Even at the top, the Start menu is aligned slightly to the left compared to the button.

So before following the below instructions, keep in mind that the taskbar may not work as intended after the changes.

Open up Windows Registry using the search bar or pressing **Windows+R** keys and using the Run command **regedit**.

Here move to the below-mentioned path. You can either copy it and paste it in the Registry search bar at the top or manually ope

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In the 2nd row under the **FE** column, change the value from **"03"** to **"01"** and click on **OK**.

You need to restart Windows Explorer to see the changes. Just press Ctrl+Shift+Esc keys to open the Task Manager, and here, right-click on the Windows Explorer process and select **Restart**. If you prefer, you can also restart the PC, and the changes will take effect.

10 Change the taskbar size.

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While the **Advanced** folder is selected, right-click on an empty space in the right panel and select **New** > **DWORD (32-bit) Value**.

Name this new key **TaskbarSi** and double-click on it to open it.

Under **Value data**, change the value to 0, 1, or 2 to change the size to small, medium, or large, respectively. Here the medium is the default Windows 11 taskbar size.

Once done, click on **OK** and restart the Windows Explorer as shown above to let the changes take effect.

Final thoughts

Along with these customization options, I will also recommend you try out third-party tools to further customize the taskbar and even get features removed in Windows 11. ExplorerPatcher is a good taskbar replacement tool for this purpose. You can even try some Windows 10 Start menu alternatives. Many of them work fine in Windows 11.

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